

KF4 Expanded Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

Let’s look at the first KF guideline: “We cooperate for the security and efficiency of the group.” Participating members cooperate to ensure a secure environment and an efficient experience for everyone by making a trustworthy effort to attend the entire meeting. By walking together through all the steps of the training, we lay the necessary foundation for the integration process and approach our healing as one entity.

Our souls need congruence; therefore, we cannot say one thing and do another without harming ourselves. In order to maintain this inner balance and integrity, we have to do what we say. We will now do our best to begin our meetings on time. This may seem rigid to some, but our meeting guidelines remind us that, as creatures living in time, we choose to honor time limitations. Our Idol Self will rebel against limitations, and some of us are not yet strong enough to defy the Idol Self. We can easily lose track of time during our sharing, so set a timer or alarm before you share to help you stay within the time restraints.

0:08 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

Through mindfulness training, you learn that you don’t have to judge or even speak when situations arise. During the next few minutes, you can quiet your mind and stop the chatter of the Idol Self.

You are training to be still in your spirit and to observe without judgment while you learn to allow whatever is happening to just *be*. During this mindfulness exercise, refuse to evaluate the performance of anyone, including yourself. Observe where your thoughts want to scatter and then gently draw them back to the breath. Take it easy and be kind to yourself in this learning process.

The 3-Minute Breathing Space¹

AWARENESS

Assume a mindfulness posture, and breathe. (*Pause*) Get to know yourself in *this* moment, in *this* space. Explore your current experience. (*Pause*) You might notice sensations in your body, or you might be aware of passing thoughts and feelings. You may find these comfortable, or you may not. Experiment with simply observing and acknowledging what is there. Just allow it to be, and observe. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

GATHERING

Gently bring your full attention to your breath, watching each in-breath and each out-breath as you breathe naturally. Where do you notice your breathing? *(Pause)* Feel your body move as it breathes. When your mind wanders, gently guide it back to your breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

EXPANDING

Expand your awareness now to include a sense of yourself as a whole person. As you breathe, feel your whole body respond to the inhale and the exhale. Observe your thoughts and feelings. Within your mind, connect your breath to your body, and connect your body to your breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Close this time by gradually re-engaging with the world around you. Open your eyes. You may want to stretch, breathe deeply, or even yawn. Experiment with allowing this connection with yourself to be your companion throughout the rest of the meeting.

During the week, you might notice how the breath is used in the Bible and in our culture.

Listen now to the first verse of the hymn *Breathe on Me, Breath of God*.

Breathe on me, Breath of God.
Fill me with life anew,
That I may love what Thou dost love,
And do what Thou wouldst do.²

Take a deep breath.

(Go straight to the Karis Confession to allow more time for the Toolbox)

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION

0:21 TOOLBOX

Our Toolbox will be longer in this lesson to give us time to practice a powerful tool called tapping.

This month we are focusing on KF Confession 1:

We confess that we have worshipped and served an Idol Self that we have created.

Wouldn't it be absolutely glorious to live a fear-free life? The term "fear-free" reminds me of cosmetics or other products that promise you that they are paraben-free, chemical-free, trans-fat-free, etc. They are saying: "You don't need to fear our product." Rather than seeking to be free from harmful substances—although that isn't a bad idea—we are working toward freeing ourselves from harmful fear. That's the direction in which you are headed. Observe how fear interferes with your whole life. Now, if you can, *think about a place in your life where there is no fear. (Repeat) (Pause)* Isn't that a wonderful place? It is usually a place of play and fun, of exploration and gratitude; it is often a place where there are people you trust. You really can learn to live, most of the time, in a place like that—free from fear.

Your connection to the Holy Spirit, to the Bible, and to a trustworthy community of believers is essential for living fear-free. Everyone needs training to develop that connection, and one of my original reasons

for creating Karis Fellowships was to provide that training for those I love. Let's review the KF tools that you now have available to support you.

1. **KF weekly meetings and the Meeting Preparation Guide**

Your first tool is your weekly KF meeting, where you are trained, healed, and have the opportunity to share your victories and your challenges. The **Meeting Preparation Guide** helps you keep a record of your efforts and progress.

As a member of Karis Fellowships, you have access to the recordings of the meetings. The playback number for your meeting is listed on the KF website. Listening to meetings during the week will help you reorient.

2. **Our manuals: the Bible and the book *Neurosis and Human Growth*³**

To help you stay on track, review your **NHG Reading Guides** and finish reading chapters 12–16 of Dr. Horney's book. Add a few minutes of Bible reading to your time of meditation or, perhaps, before or after a meal.

Here is a quote from Robert Louis Stevenson:

You cannot run away from weakness; you must at some time fight it out or perish;
and if that be so, why not now, and where you stand?⁴

The book study helps you identify areas of weakness where you need to stand against your fears and fight it out.

3. **Mindfulness and meditation practice**

Mindfulness training teaches you to observe reality with your mind, calm your body, and exercise endurance, all of which strengthens your True Self.

4. **Worksheets and guides—homework for lasting recovery**

As the weeks go by, you will have access to a variety of worksheets and guides that support your efforts to rescue and repair your True Self. These documents are tools for your recovery, so you will want to keep them close by and easily accessible. You might keep a copy of the worksheets in a ring binder along with your **Meeting Preparation Guides** and your **Meeting Schedule**. You can also fill in and file the worksheets on your computer, but we want to remember that handwriting our work is more beneficial for our brains, our bodies, and our healing.

5. **Tapping—when the going gets rough**

Tapping is one of the tools that we use in KF to train hard so that we can fight easy when dealing with our weaknesses and fears. We don't try to meet the fear on its own turf. We don't go into our heads and try to figure it out. We don't use methods like self-discipline, positive confession, willpower, or self-punishment to overcome our fear. Nor do we try to make others take responsibility for our fear by bullying them, manipulating them, or avoiding them. Often, just to get relief from the fear of helplessness, the fear of change, the fear of personal responsibility, and any other fear, we abuse ourselves and others, misuse substances, and engage in all kinds of misoriented behavior. We also generate emotions or seek stimulation to distract ourselves and relieve the tension that comes with fear. Of course, we then hate ourselves for having resorted to unhealthy habits to escape our discomfort. Self-hate invariably creates fear and generates tension, and we may tell stories about our

fear and tension to exonerate our behavior. When we are caught in this pattern of generating and relieving tension, we get confused about what we want to be doing, what needs doing, and with whom we want to do it. Here is an example:

Having sold his home, a man had a large amount of money in a savings account. A trusted friend encouraged him to invest part of that money with a reputable financial planner. He agreed to meet with the financial planner but felt acute self-hate because of his lack of knowledge. He told himself the story that he should be able to grasp in a couple of hours what the financial planner had spent decades learning. His self-hate created an unconscious compulsive need to sabotage himself, so in the meeting he confused himself by asking all kinds of irrelevant questions. His questions also confused the financial planner, and this gave the man a sense of vindictive triumph. The man's pride compelled him to control the meeting, but as he was unable to ask truly clarifying questions, the answers he received did not satisfy him. He left the meeting without any clear direction for his finances, secretly accusing the financial planner of withholding information.

This man's self-hate sabotaged an opportunity to invest his money. As a result, he is now completely confused about what he wants, what his goals are, and how to meet them. To protect his pride, he constantly congratulates himself on having made the effort to learn about financial matters, and he tells himself the story that he is far too intelligent to make an investment about which he has doubts. He feels complacent pride in his imagined financial acumen, which in his mind prevented him from trusting a stranger with his money. However, he lives with chronic self-hate because he was unable to understand the whole world of finance in a couple of hours. When others talk about their investments, he hates himself for not having a successful investment portfolio of his own.

Tapping is a very effective method for managing our fear and calming us down when we feel the compulsive need to abuse, use, or confuse. Stored information in our bodies drives us to react before we can think, so we work with our bodies first. Tapping is like a tune-up that reprograms our bodies. With calmer bodies, we have more freedom to choose healthier outcomes. In KF, we learn to approach our fear by stealth, like guerilla soldiers who undermine the enemy's power before they go into battle. Even prayer can be counter-productive when our prayers focus on our fear. Tapping defuses fear. One day I showed a woman how to tap. She was dying of cancer, and her life was completely saturated with fear. After tapping, the intensity of her fear dropped to half of what it was before. She immediately began to see the results of experiencing less fear in her life.

I hope that you were able to download the **Tapping Protocol** from the Karis Fellowships website. You can also watch [Alison's tapping and TAT videos](#) which demonstrate this tool and your Karis Link might be able to help you. While I read, follow along in your notes and participate as best you can. Some of you already know how to use this tool and have experienced how powerful it can be. Don't worry about getting this perfectly right. Simply do your best with the intention of becoming fear-free.

The Tapping Protocol⁵

Before you begin tapping, you need to formulate your healing statement and write it down. This statement describes the problem that triggered your stress reaction and, also, identifies a few of the

emotions that you are experiencing. Allow yourself to play with this a little. The statement does not have to be perfectly crafted.

For this session, I will use the **Tapping Protocol** to help me overcome my anxiety about a current life change. I will start by imagining the potential chaos that this life change might bring—and I have lots of experiences to draw upon! I will ask myself: *What is going on in my emotions?* Mindfulness training gives me tools that help me answer this question. It trains me to focus in the moment and be aware of what I am feeling.

Having identified both my problem and my emotions, I am ready to write my healing statement, which goes like this: *My problem is that I am experiencing a life change, and when I think of that, I feel lonely, distressed, anxious, and vulnerable.*

Now let's go step by step through the process of creating a personal healing statement.

1. Determine the focus

What is the problem or issue that you want to address? You might consider one of the fears that you noticed this week. Your problem would be whatever triggered the fear. Begin with the phrase ***"My problem is that . . ."*** and then state the problem in simple terms. (*Pause for 15 seconds*)

Sometimes we imagine that fear is our problem, so we get confused and want to start our statement with *"My problem is that I feel fear . . ."* Instead, try to identify the event that triggered the fear. Your mindfulness training will help you make that connection. When did you start feeling the fear? What happened that caused a spike of anxiety?

2. Identify your emotions

What do you feel when you think about your problem? (*Pause*) Add to your healing statement ***"and when I think of that, I feel . . ."*** Now list a few of the emotions that you have identified. (*Pause for 15 seconds*)

You might find it helpful to refer to the lists of emotions on the KF worksheets.

3. Write down your complete healing statement

Here is my example again: *My problem is that I am experiencing a life change, and when I think of that, I feel lonely, distressed, anxious, and vulnerable.* Be sure to write down your healing statement and keep it in a place where you can easily find it again for your KF work.

If this healing statement doesn't feel comfortable for you, try beginning your statement with the words ***"I am releasing the . . ."*** Now state whatever fear, trauma, anxiety, or craving need you might be experiencing. My own healing statement might then be: *I am releasing the anxiety of facing a life change.* A preliminary tap using this simpler format might help clear your mind so that you can construct a more comprehensive healing statement for a second tap.

Here are the two models again:

- ***My problem is [state the problem], and when I think of that, I feel [list your feeling(s)].***
- ***I am releasing the [trauma of, feeling of, need to, fear of, etc.].***

Remember that the intention to heal is more powerful than the exact wording.

4. Assess the level of fear or stress

On a scale of one to ten, with ten being the most stressful for you, how stressful is your problem? Make a note of that. *(Pause)*

Let's practice the first series of the **Tapping Protocol** together.

Sip some purified water and assume a mindfulness posture. Be sure to breathe deeply while you tap. You might want to make noise with your breathing to help you focus.

Opening

With the palm of each hand flat on your chest, rub in a circular motion crossing over the sternum. While rubbing, breathe deeply and repeat this statement after me:

I fully and completely accept myself as I am today. (Read 3 times, pausing for 3 seconds after each reading)

Now pause.

First Series

Continue to breathe deeply as you follow my guidance.

- *Using the three middle fingers of each hand, tap gently on the orbital bones under your eyes. (Repeat) Read your healing statement out loud and then breathe deeply as you tap: **"My problem is . . ., and when I think of that, I feel . . ."** (Pause for 15 seconds)*
- Now, under your dominant arm, which is most often the right arm, find a point about four inches below the armpit. Massage this rather tender spot as you repeat your healing statement. Try not to worry about finding the exact location. *(Pause for 15 seconds)*
- Pause. With the palm of each hand facing you, push your little fingers away from you and bring your two ring fingers together so that they touch each other. *Bring all the middle fingers together to form a kind of picket fence and tap on your brow, above your nose, with all six fingertips. (Repeat) Breathe, and repeat your healing statement. (Pause for 15 seconds)*
- Locate your collarbone and follow it out to your shoulder joints. Drop down about two inches into the crevice between your shoulders and chest muscles. Massage these two points and repeat your statement. You might find it easier to cross your arms over your chest while you do this. Breathe. *(Pause for 15 seconds)*
- Now, follow your collarbone back to the sternum. Drop down about two inches on each side of the sternum and tap or massage the space between your ribs. Repeat your statement, and breathe. *(Pause for 15 seconds)*
- Move to the little finger of your left hand. *With the three middle fingers of your right hand, tap on the inside edge of the left little finger, incorporating the edge of the fingernail. (Repeat) Repeat your statement, and breathe. (Pause for 15 seconds)*

- Pause. Take a deep breath and sip some water. On a scale of one to ten, how distressing is the problem or trigger event now? Jot down the number for your reference. *(Pause)*

This is the first series of the **Tapping Protocol**. In the next lesson we will learn the second series. For a much more effective tap, spend twenty seconds on each step.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Father, remind me to tap. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?")

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

We will be spending some weeks in the letter from James, so you might want to print out the first chapter of James from one of the many Bible websites. Double or triple space the text to give yourself room for taking notes, and keep a copy in your ring binder with your other KF materials.

Let's look at **James 1:2**.

The NASB translation reads: "Consider it all joy, my brethren, when you encounter various trials."⁶ Last week, we learned that the Greek word for *consider* can be translated as *guide yourself*. We can guide ourselves into all joy in any situation. Isn't that amazing? However, you might wonder where this joy is that we are guiding ourselves into. Most of us have no idea where to find joy, but fortunately we do not have to know where we are going before we begin the journey. Like all journeys, we must simply begin. Jesus really is *The Way*, and on this journey toward reclaiming the True Self, we discover more and more about who He is and who we are becoming.⁷ This is the source of all joy.

What are these *various trials* that James talks about? We have learned during these last weeks that trials or experiences are opportunities to discover the truth about who we are and where our real strengths and weaknesses lie. In our passage from First John, we learned that these trials are days of judgment.⁸ They show us the truth about our beliefs and our fearful misorientation. Just as a courtroom will explore what is true, so this day of judgment will explore our hearts and reveal the true quality of our faith and love. Although this experience might sound intimidating, John says that we can be bold in this day of judgment. We get to see how much fear we are carrying in our souls. We also get to see how far we have travelled toward our goal of reorienting to God and living in harmony with His Creation. We no longer shrink back through fear of self-hate.⁹ All of this knowing leads to our growing, and growing leads to more knowing. Through knowing and growing we gain real self-confidence. Just as the lilies grow without fear, so can you.¹⁰

In the early days of Karis Fellowships, my husband and I drove to Lake Elsinore. On that drive, we talked about how difficult these new ideas might be for some of you, especially if you have been trained to think in a certain way. Our KF work reminds me of how difficult it must have been for those listening to Jesus for the first time. Jesus invited them to rethink their whole culture and upbringing. They naturally felt intimidated and resistant. I thought about a time, years ago, long before we ever thought of Karis

Fellowships, when I was agonizing about where *Neurosis and Human Growth* and the Romans Bible study would take me.¹¹ I was afraid of my own journey toward orientation; I was afraid of going into the not-knowing. I think fear confuses all of us. When we are in fear, we feel abandoned, and in those moments, we need to be reminded that Jesus is with us. Several years ago, while in prayer, the Lord plainly spoke to me. He said, *“You must be willing to go into the not-knowing.” (Repeat)* At that time, I really did not know what He meant, but all the same His words encouraged me to let go of needing to know where this journey would take me.

Let me point out something. Letting go of anything is a day of judgment—and it is probably one of our more severe trials or experiments. We find out where our treasure is when we cannot let go, and that can be extremely painful. Some of us have a compulsive need to be *right*. I have always felt that I needed to know the *right* theology, the *right* way to do something, what is *right* about myself, about society, about the choices of others, and what is *wrong* about all of those things. I had to know what was right in order to support my pride and relieve my anxiety. During that year, God encouraged me to give up needing to know what was right. He encouraged me to just keep growing—or, shall I say, to keep going forward on the journey, producing more of the Fruit of the Spirit in my life. I knew in my heart that if I allowed the fear of being wrong to hold me back, I would be obeying my fears. I would be teaching my heart to love fear rather than to love God. What a loss that would have been! If I had followed my fears, I would not have these healing gifts to offer to my community, nor would we have Karis Fellowships.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Jesus, help me go into the not-knowing with You. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?”)

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes, perhaps in a KF journal. Assume a mindfulness posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider going on this journey with Jesus, not knowing where you are going. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

The FAITH Process

(Choose from each section a few sentences that are meaningful to you)

Feelings

As you *consider going on this journey with Jesus, not knowing where you are going*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* You can learn to recognize and honor your feelings without allowing them to master you. Acknowledge your experience with compassion, whatever it may be, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Awareness without judgment

Gently allow whatever you are experiencing to rest in your awareness. You might notice a compulsion to push thoughts or feelings away, to judge them, or to justify them. We often flush thoughts or feelings

from our awareness before they have a chance to teach us. As you breathe, hold your thoughts and feelings up to the light. Observe whatever you may be experiencing as you *consider going on this journey with Jesus, not knowing where you are going*. (Pause) Feelings and passing thoughts are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Breathe, and bring your attention to your body. Notice what it is doing when you *consider going on this journey with Jesus, not knowing where you are going*. What sensations are there? (Pause) Your body is always talking to you. You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. For example, you might recognize what anxiety or resistance feels like in your body. You might feel curiosity or courage. (Pause) If your sensations are uncomfortable, you can move your attention to an area of your body that is not reacting, and rest. When you are ready, return to observe those uncomfortable sensations. Breathe. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider going on this journey with Him, not knowing where you are going*. Do you feel comfortable with that, uncomfortable, or are you shutting down? Just observe. (Pause) Do you judge this journey as good or evil? (Pause) What are your reasons? What story do you want to tell? (Pause) Is this experience a regular pattern in your life? (Pause) Are you afraid of something—of loss, of others, or of yourself? Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Heal

God created you to have all of these feelings, and for thousands of years human beings have been feeling like you do when they have gone into the not-knowing. You are not alone in your feelings. You are a human creature. (Pause) Feelings are just chemical reactions in your body bringing you information. With training, you can choose what you will do with that information. (Pause) You can observe and learn something from what you have just experienced. When a fear or judgment signals you through the body, you can focus on your body and your breath rather than getting caught up in a story and reacting. Breathe, and allow yourself to feel compassion for all human creatures who are driven by fear. Help your body process with a long exhaling breath. (Pause for 30 seconds)

Pause. Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?”)

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank you for this time together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?”)

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

If you would like more support for your training, you might consider KF mini-meetings. Ask your Karis Link about this tool.

The KF book study of *Honor, Patronage, Kinship, and Purity* (HPKP) by Dr. David deSilva begins soon.¹² This study has helped many KF members explore the integrity of their own Christian beliefs in the context of first century values and culture.

¹ Zindel Segal, J. Mark G Williams, and John D Teasdale, *Mindfulness-Based Cognitive Therapy for Depression* (New York: Guilford Press, 2013), 208. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

² *Breathe on Me, Breath of God* by Edwin Hatch (1835-1889), www.youtube.com/watch?v=M5keJHZdWYM.

³ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991).

⁴ "Robert Louis Stevenson Quotes," *Goodreads*, accessed April 24, 2016, www.goodreads.com/author/quotes/854076.Robert_Louis_Stevenson.

⁵ Dr. Roger Callahan, "TFT Stress Buster Tapping Class-Learn to Use TFT Tapping," Callahan Techniques, accessed April 24, 2016, www.rogercallahan.com/learn-to-tap.php. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.

⁶ Gen. 1: 26–28 (New American Standard Bible).

⁷ John 14:6.

⁸ 1 John 4:17. (See KF2 Bible Teaching)

⁹ Heb. 10:38.

¹⁰ Matt. 6:28.

¹¹ Karen Horney, *Neurosis and Human Growth* (New York: Norton, 1991); Nancy Diven, *KF Romans Bible Study*.

¹² David A. deSilva, *Honor, Patronage, Kinship, and Purity* (Downers Grove: Intervarsity Press, 2000).